

PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

ServiceNow IT Service Management Project

Project Type	Individual Project
Domain	Information Technology / IT Service Management
Platform	ServiceNow
Project Area	Incident Management and Lifecycle Automation

1. Ideation Phase

The idea for this project was to develop an automated Incident Management solution in ServiceNow. In an IT support environment, incidents need to be recorded, classified, assigned to the appropriate support team, investigated, resolved, and finally closed. Manual handling of these activities can result in delays, inconsistent processes, and difficulty tracking the status of incidents.

The proposed solution uses ServiceNow to streamline the incident lifecycle and provide a structured process from incident creation to resolution. The project also considers Knowledge Management and Change Management so that known solutions can be reused and recurring issues can be handled more effectively.

1.1 Project Idea

- Create and manage incidents in ServiceNow.
- Classify incidents according to category, impact, urgency, and priority.
- Assign incidents to appropriate support groups and users.
- Track incidents through their lifecycle.
- Use automation to reduce repetitive manual activities.
- Integrate knowledge articles to support faster resolution.
- Use change management when an incident requires a controlled change.

1.2 Expected Benefits

- Faster incident resolution.
- Better visibility of incident status and ownership.
- Standardized incident-handling process.
- Improved use of existing knowledge.
- Reduced recurring incidents through structured problem/change handling.
- Improved IT service efficiency.

2. Requirement Analysis

The requirement analysis phase identifies what the Incident Lifecycle Automation solution must provide. The requirements are divided into functional and non-functional requirements.

2.1 Functional Requirements

- Users should be able to create incident records.
- The system should capture caller, short description, description, category, impact, urgency, and priority.
- Incidents should be assigned to a suitable assignment group.
- Support teams should be able to update work notes and additional comments.
- The incident state should change according to the lifecycle.
- Resolved incidents should contain resolution information.
- Closed incidents should be retained for reporting and tracking.
- Knowledge articles should be available to support incident resolution.
- Change Management should be used when a controlled change is required.

2.2 Non-Functional Requirements

- The solution should be easy for support users to operate.
- Incident information should be consistently maintained.
- Access to incident data should follow ServiceNow roles and security controls.
- The system should provide traceability of incident activities.
- The process should be scalable for a larger number of incidents.

2.3 Main Users / Roles

Role	Responsibility	Project Usage
Caller / User	Reports an issue	Creates or is associated with an incident
Service Desk	Initial incident handling	Classifies, prioritizes and assigns incidents
Assignment Group	Technical support	Investigates and resolves incidents
ServiceNow Administrator	Platform configuration	Configures tables, forms, automation and security

3. Project Design Phase

The design phase defines how the proposed solution will work inside ServiceNow. The incident lifecycle is designed as a controlled flow in which each stage has a specific purpose and responsible user or support team.

3.1 High-Level Incident Lifecycle

Incident Creation → Classification → Prioritization → Assignment → Investigation → Resolution → Closure

3.2 Incident Data Design

- Incident Number – unique identifier for each incident.
- Caller – user who reports or is affected by the issue.
- Short Description – brief summary of the incident.
- Description – detailed explanation of the issue.
- Category / Subcategory – classification of the issue.
- Impact – business or user impact.
- Urgency – required speed of response.
- Priority – calculated/assigned based on impact and urgency.
- Assignment Group – support team responsible for the incident.
- Assigned To – individual responsible for handling the incident.
- State – current stage of the incident lifecycle.
- Work Notes / Additional Comments – communication and investigation history.
- Resolution Information – details of how the incident was resolved.

3.3 Automation Design

- Use ServiceNow workflow/automation capabilities to support lifecycle activities.
- Route incidents to appropriate support groups.
- Use conditions to control actions at different stages.

- Notify relevant users or support teams when required.
- Use knowledge articles when a known solution is available.
- Initiate or associate a change when the incident requires a controlled change.

3.4 Security Design

ServiceNow roles and access controls are considered in the design so that users can perform only the activities appropriate to their responsibilities.

4. Project Planning Phase

The project was planned as a sequence of manageable phases. Each phase focuses on a specific part of the ServiceNow solution, from requirements through implementation and validation.

4.1 Planned Work Breakdown

Phase	Major Activities	Expected Output
Ideation	Identify problem, proposed solution and benefits	Project concept
Requirement Analysis	Identify users, requirements and incident process	Requirement specification
Project Design	Design lifecycle, data, automation and security	Solution design
Project Planning	Break work into phases and tasks	Implementation plan
Project Development	Configure and test ServiceNow solution	Working project

4.2 Development Task Plan

- Configure the required ServiceNow incident-management components.
- Create/configure users, groups and roles required for the process.
- Configure incident fields, forms and lists.
- Implement incident classification and prioritization.
- Configure assignment and lifecycle handling.
- Configure notifications and supporting automation where required.
- Connect incident handling with Knowledge Management.
- Consider Change Management for incidents requiring changes.
- Test the complete incident lifecycle.
- Document the completed implementation with screenshots and results.

5. Project Development Phase

In the development phase, the planned solution was implemented on the ServiceNow platform. The project focuses on creating a structured Incident Management process and supporting it with ServiceNow configuration and automation.

5.1 ServiceNow Environment Setup

- Used a ServiceNow development/practice instance.
- Configured the required users, groups and roles.

- Used the Incident table and related ServiceNow functionality.

5.2 Incident Record Creation

Incident records were created to represent IT issues reported by users. Each record contains the information required to identify, classify, prioritize and assign the issue.

Screenshot Placeholder: Insert screenshot of your Incident record here.

5.3 Incident Classification and Prioritization

Incidents were classified using fields such as category and subcategory. Impact and urgency are used to determine the appropriate priority so that critical issues can receive suitable attention.

Screenshot Placeholder: Insert screenshot showing Category, Impact, Urgency and Priority.

5.4 Assignment and Investigation

After classification, incidents are assigned to the appropriate support group and, when required, to an individual. Support users can record investigation details through work notes and communicate with the caller using additional comments.

Screenshot Placeholder: Insert screenshot showing Assignment Group and Assigned To.

5.5 Resolution and Closure

Once the technical issue is resolved, resolution information is recorded and the incident moves through the appropriate resolution and closure stages. This provides a complete history of the incident.

Screenshot Placeholder: Insert screenshot showing Resolution Information and State.

5.6 Knowledge Management Integration

Knowledge Management supports the incident process by providing reusable solutions for known issues. Support teams can use relevant knowledge articles to reduce investigation time and improve consistency in incident resolution.

Screenshot Placeholder: Insert screenshot of Knowledge Article / Knowledge search.

5.7 Change Management Integration

When an incident requires a system or infrastructure change, Change Management can be used to ensure that the change is planned, controlled and tracked. This helps reduce risk while resolving the underlying issue.

Screenshot Placeholder: Insert screenshot of Change-related configuration or record if available.

5.8 Testing

- Created test incident records.
- Verified required incident information was captured.
- Verified classification and prioritization.
- Verified assignment to support groups/users.
- Verified incident state/lifecycle progression.
- Verified resolution and closure information.

- Verified supporting Knowledge Management functionality.
- Verified Change Management usage where applicable.

5.9 Final Outcome

The completed project demonstrates an Incident Lifecycle Automation solution in ServiceNow. The solution provides a structured process from incident creation to resolution and supports faster and more consistent IT service operations through automation, knowledge reuse and controlled change management.

Conclusion

The Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow project demonstrates how ServiceNow can be used to manage IT incidents through a standardized lifecycle. The project covers ideation, requirements, solution design, planning and development. It also demonstrates the relationship between Incident Management, Knowledge Management and Change Management in improving IT service efficiency.

Appendix – Project Screenshots

Add your actual ServiceNow screenshots in this section. Recommended screenshots include:

- Incident list / incident record.
- Incident classification and priority.
- Assignment Group and Assigned To.
- Incident state/lifecycle.
- Work Notes and Additional Comments.
- Resolution and closure.
- Knowledge Management.
- Change Management.

Project Screenshots – Development Evidence

The following screenshots provide visual evidence of the ServiceNow implementation performed for the Incident Lifecycle Automation project.

5.1 Incident Record – Details View

This screenshot shows incident INC0010048 in the Service Operations Workspace. It contains the short description, detailed description, state, caller, activity area, and SLA information.

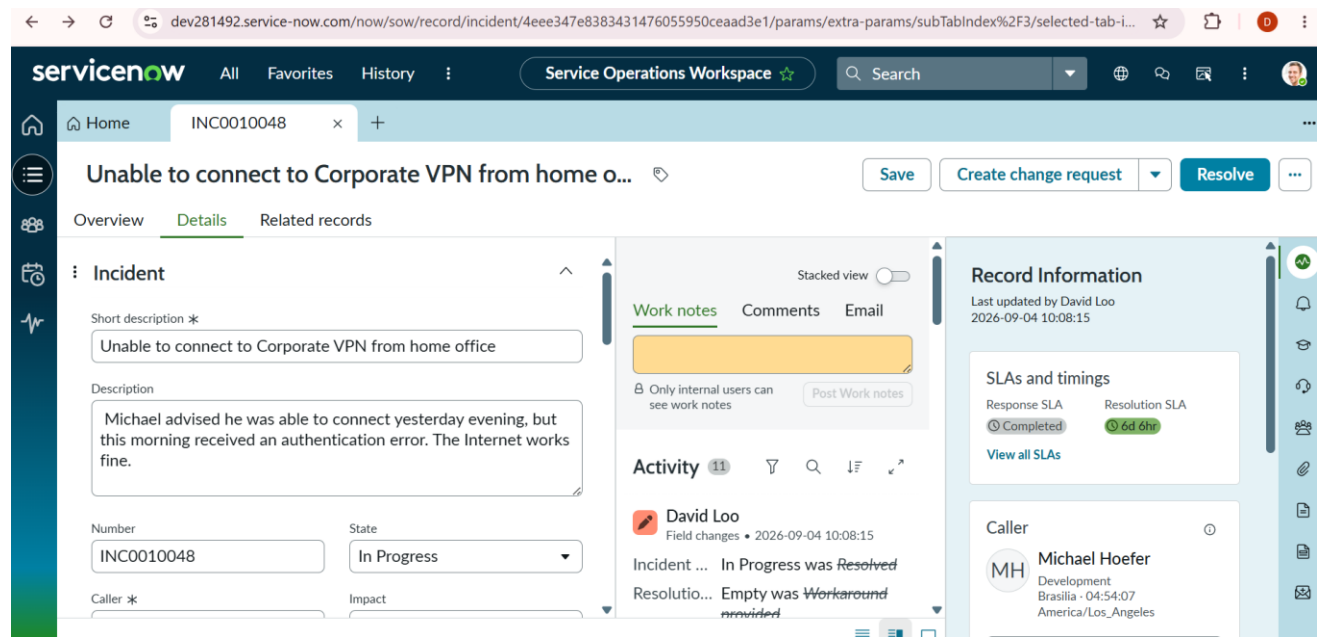


Figure 1: Incident INC0010048 – Details and SLA information.

5.2 Incident Overview

This screenshot shows the Overview tab for incident INC0010048, including the incident summary, priority, impact, urgency, activity history, and SLA details.

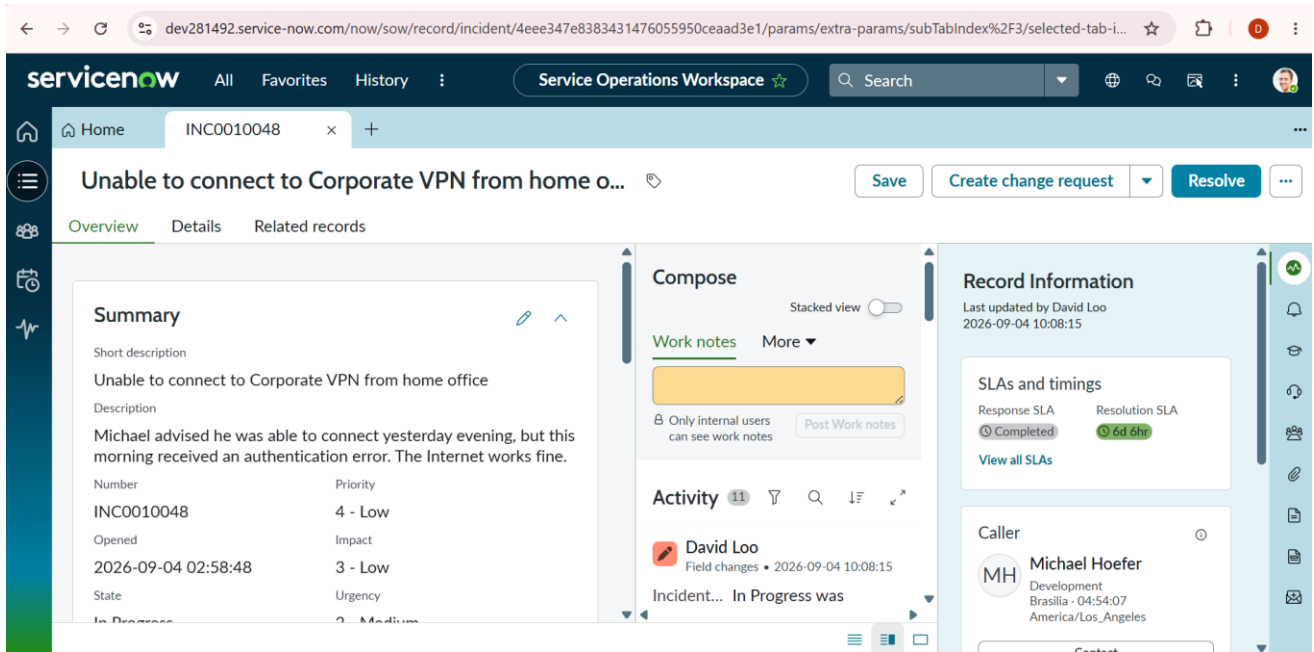


Figure 2: Incident INC0010048 – Overview and activity.

5.3 Child Incident Record

This screenshot shows child incident INC0010053 created for the Corporate VPN connectivity issue. It demonstrates a separate incident record with its own description, priority, caller, and assignment information.

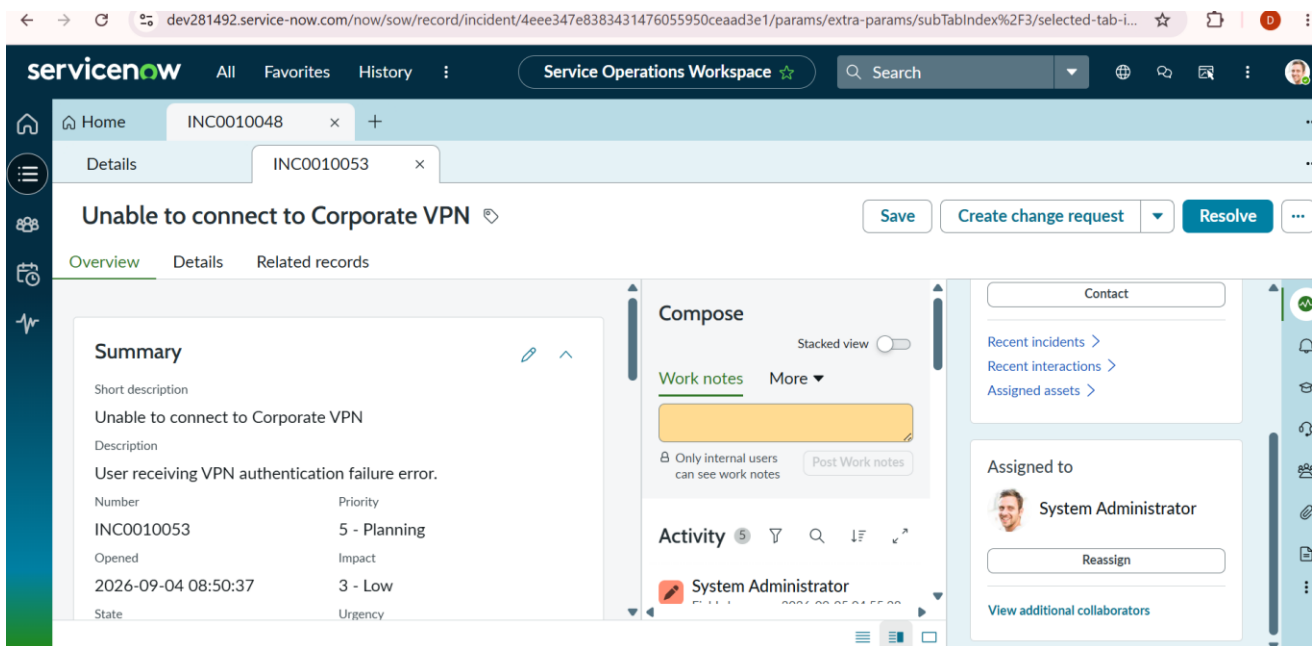


Figure 3: Child incident INC0010053 – Corporate VPN issue.

Screenshot Evidence Mapping

Screenshot	ServiceNow Evidence	Development Activity
Figure 1	INC0010048 Details	Incident record details, state, activity and SLA
Figure 2	INC0010048 Overview	Incident summary, priority, impact

		and urgency
Figure 3	INC0010053	Child incident creation and record details